DECISION SHEET

Standard(s)- (year and edition):	**Sub clause(s):**	**Sheet n°:**
IEC 60601-1:1988 Ed.2 Am1+Am2	6.8.2 6.8.2 e)	**DSH-419**
Subject: Internal battery for back-up power	**Key words:** Internal battery, Protective earth terminal	**Ce confirmed by CTL at its 39th meeting, in Cologne**

Question:

The requirement in this clause seems to be a little unreasonable. Assume for example, EQUIPMENT with an internal battery intended for back-up power in the event of a failure of the SUPPLY MAINS as a power source. Further, how can one say whether the external PROTECTIVE EARTH CONDUCTOR arrangement is in doubt or not?

Decision:

The Instructions for use shall include for CLASS I EQUIPMENT the following statement:
"WARNING: THIS EQUIPMENT MUST ONLY BE CONNECTED TO A SUPPLY MAINS WITH PROTECTIVE EARTH."

Explanatory notes:

This appears to be directed at EQUIPMENT used in the home, where the integrity of the protective earth may be less certain. This decision is intended to draw an unskilled user's attention to the importance of protective earthing.